

giate, is far greater. For there, example teacheth, company comforteth, emulation quickeneth, glory raiseth. Certainly the great multiplication of virtues upon human nature resteth upon societies well ordained and disciplined." §

Things are sometimes best displayed by the side of their contraries. It has been the benign aim of patriot legislators to disseminate knowledge: it has been the infernal wish of despots and the minions of despots to extinguish it. The political principles of Mr. Hobbes are well known. Such an abhorrence he contracted for popular government, and the principles of freedom, that he was anxious to see both extirpated from the face of the earth. In order to obtain this consummation, in his perverted judgment so devoutly to be wished, he recommends it to princes to destroy the Greek and Latin authors. "By reading them," says he, "men have, under a false show of liberty, acquired a habit of favouring tumults, and of licentiously controlling the conduct of their sovereigns." ^h In France, during a late reign, a minister was heard to say—"I will put an end to all schools;" and another is said to have declared—"I am tired with these publications; if I continue ten years longer in office, I am determined that no books, except the court calender, shall be printed in Paris." ⁱ But in France, that late reign is now passed.

The same savage and tyrannick maxims have, in former times, been avowed in America. But those times are now also passed. It will not, however, be unuseful

§ 3. Ld. Bac. 357. 358.

^h Lev. P. 2. c. 21. 1. Shaft. Char. 88.

ⁱ Fr. Rev. 266.